P&C People Skills · Course 1 · Week 2

Look Beyond the Reaction

SLO

- 1.3 Interpret a reaction as a signal of an underlying need, fear or pressure, without taking it personally or jumping to conclusions

Models taught

- The Iceberg model of behaviour: the reaction is the tip; needs, fears and pressures sit below
- SCARF (David Rock, 2008): Status, Certainty, Autonomy, Relatedness, Fairness, taught as a practical lens rather than proven neuroscience
- In the moment: Pause → Probe → Pin → Respond

Situations walked through step by step

- Certainty: a new joiner snaps at you over a laptop delay ("Am I set up to succeed?")
- Status: a senior employee goes quiet after a restructure announcement (the issue is status, not the change)

20 spoken lines · 261 words · about 1.9 min + Taleemabad intro/outro · LearnFree-style visuals · voice spoken to "you"

#	Spoken line	On screen
01	When someone snaps at you, the reaction is rarely the real story. read: calmly, with a knowing warmth	Title card: **Beyond the Reaction**, *why people react the way they do*
02	Think of an iceberg: the reaction is only the small tip you can see. read: thoughtfully, painting a picture	Iceberg: tip The reaction
03	Below the waterline sit the needs, fears and beliefs that really drive it. read: slowly, with gentle insight	Iceberg: tip The reaction; below the waterline: Needs, Fears, Beliefs
04	A model called SCARF, from David Rock, helps you name what is underneath. read: clearly, introducing a useful tool	Model **SCARF**: S · C · A · R · F *(David Rock, 2008)*
05	It names five things people protect at work: status, certainty, autonomy, relatedness and fairness. read: steadily, one idea at a time	Model **SCARF**: S Status · C Certainty · A Autonomy · R Relatedness · F Fairness
06	Being sidelined hits status, uncertainty hits certainty, and being left out hits relatedness. read: with recognition, as if naming familiar moments	Model **SCARF**: **S Sidelined** · **C Uncertainty** · A · **R Left out** · F
07	When one feels threatened, we react as if under attack, and clear thinking drops. read: gently, with a note of caution	Iceberg: tip Snap · go quiet · push back; below the waterline: Threatened need (an alarm pulses on the tip)
08	So in the moment, you use four steps: pause, probe, pin and respond. read: confidently, giving a simple plan	Model **In the moment**: 1 Pause · 2 Probe · 3 Pin · 4 Respond
09	Say a new joiner snaps at you because their laptop still has not arrived. read: setting the scene, lightly	A person speaks: "Day three and still no laptop. Brilliant."
10	First, pause, and do not argue with the tip of the iceberg. read: calmly, steadying the moment	Model **In the moment**: **1 Pause** · 2 Probe · 3 Pin · 4 Respond
11	Then probe, gently: what worries you most about the delay? read: curious and kind	A person speaks: "What worries you most about the delay?"

#	Spoken line	On screen
12	They admit everyone else is working, and they worry they look useless. read: quietly, letting the real answer land	A person speaks: "Everyone is working. I look like I can't do the job."
13	Pin it: this is certainty, the question am I set up to succeed? read: with the satisfaction of a puzzle solved	Model **SCARF**: S · **C Certainty** · A · R · F · on screen: "Am I set up to succeed?"
14	So you respond to that need, with a firm date and a useful plan for today. read: warmly and practically	A person speaks: "It arrives Thursday. Today, you shadow the team lead."
15	Now a senior employee goes quiet after a restructure is announced. read: more seriously, raising the stakes	Iceberg: tip Goes quiet in meetings

⏸ CHECKPOINT: the video pauses here; the LMS asks; the learner must answer to continue. *(Not in the video.)*

Q: A senior employee has gone quiet since a restructure moved their team under a newer manager. What do you do first?

A. Explain the business reasons for the restructure to them again
B. Ask them privately how the change lands, and ask for their read on the new setup ✓
C. Leave it for now; they will adjust in a few weeks
D. Tell them in the team meeting that their role matters as much as ever

If right: Exactly. The quiet is the tip of the iceberg; underneath is status. Asking privately, and asking for their expert read, gives back the standing the change took away.

If wrong: The need underneath is status, so you respond to that: ask privately how it lands, and ask for their read on the new setup, which shows their experience still counts. Explaining the business reasons again answers certainty, not status, and can feel like a lecture. Leaving it lets the silence harden into disengagement. Reassuring them in the team meeting puts them on the spot in front of others, which can make the status threat worse, and it tells rather than shows.

17	Pin it: the change itself is not the issue; their status is. read: with clarity, naming the need	Model **SCARF**: **S Status** · C · A · R · F · on screen: "Where do I stand now?"
18	So you ask for their read privately, and give their experience a real role. read: warmly, with respect	A person speaks: "You know this team best. What would you change in the new setup?"
19	Understanding the need does not excuse the behaviour; you handle both, the need first. read: firmly but gently	Split: **Excuse ≠ Understand**
20	And keep SCARF as your private lens; never tell someone they have a status threat. read: as quiet, practical advice	Model **Your private lens**: S Status · C Certainty · A Autonomy · R Relatedness · F Fairness
21	So look below the waterline, name the need, and respond to that. read: warmly and with energy, a confident close	Recap cards: See the iceberg · Name the need with SCARF · Pause, probe, pin, respond